

WISDOM PAVES THE WAY

Let us do these activities before we read.

- I Why do we seek advice of the elderly in our family? Share your thoughts with your classmates and teacher.
- II Knowledge is about learning facts and information, while wisdom is about using that knowledge with good judgement.

Work in pairs. Read the following situations and classify each one as either 'knowledge' or 'wisdom'. One example has been done for you.

1. Riya's understanding of plant care helped her grow a healthy vegetable garden in her backyard.
2. Mr. Kumar values time with family over chasing wealth.
3. Karuna's expertise in computer programming helped her develop a successful app.
4. Rohan understood the value of time management and created a timetable to complete his assignments systematically.
5. Ramesh chose to forgive his friend for a misunderstanding.
6. Ms. Vaijayanthi delivered a lecture on Indian Classical music at the cultural festival.

Knowledge	Wisdom
1.	

- III Observe the picture carefully. What do you think might have happened? Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.





Let us read

Characters

THE KING OF UJJAIN : a young King

FOUR YOUNG MEN : Ram Datt, Shiv Datt, Har Datt, and Dev Datt

THE MERCHANT

TWO SENTRIES

SETTING : A road leading to Ujjain, visible in the distance. Later, the King's court, **adorned** with rich **tapestries**, tall pillars, and regal decor. The time is midday.

adorned:
beautified

tapestries:
heavy
decorative
fabrics woven
with pictures or
patterns

resolute:
determined

bustling: busy

Scene I: The Road to Ujjain

*(Four young men—Ram Datt, Shiv Datt, Har Datt, and Dev Datt—are walking along a dusty road leading to Ujjain. They appear travel-worn but **resolute**, their eyes fixed on the city that looms ahead. The sun is high, and the distant noise of the **bustling** city faintly reaches them.)*



RAM DATT : (*Wiping his brow*) We have journeyed far from home, yet the prospect of finding work still **eludes** us.

eludes: difficult to obtain

HAR DATT : How long has it been since we left our village?

SHIV DATT : I believe it has been over a week—perhaps even longer.

RAM DATT : Ten days, to be precise. Every day feels longer than the last.

DEV DATT : Ten days are but a short span in the grand scheme of things. We may still have many more roads to wander before we find employment befitting all four of us.

RAM DATT : If only we could secure an audience with the King of Ujjain. I am confident he would recognise our talents and appoint us to his service.

SHIV DATT : I share your belief.

DEV DATT : Indeed, we ought to be united in this hope. That is why we press on towards Ujjain.

HAR DATT : (*Pausing thoughtfully*) Gaining an audience with the King is no simple task. We need to **devise** a strategy.

devise: (here) to think of

DEV DATT : Let us reach the city gates first. We can **deliberate** once we are closer.

deliberate: to think carefully

(As they walk, Ram Datt notices something on the ground.)



scrutinise: to
look carefully at

in haste: in a
hurry

pursued: (here)
chased

countenance:
facial
expression

distressed:
worried

SHIV DATT : Look there, friends. A camel has passed this way. The tracks are fresh.

RAM DATT : *(Studying the tracks)* Yes, let us observe them as we continue. They may tell us more than meets the eye. *(The four men continue walking, occasionally stopping to examine the camel's tracks. They **scrutinise** every detail, exchanging glances but saying little.)*

RAM DATT : I have discovered something peculiar about this camel.

SHIV DATT : So have I.

HAR DATT : I, too, have noticed a strange detail.

DEV DATT : *(Smiling)* It seems each of us has learnt something unique, yet I believe my discovery is unlike any of yours.

HAR DATT : Let us rest beneath a large tree and share our findings. But wait—someone approaches **in haste**!

SHIV DATT : *(Peering ahead)* It appears to be a merchant, running as if **pursued** by trouble.

RAM DATT : A merchant indeed, and judging by his **countenance**, he has lost something of great value—perhaps his camel.

*(The Merchant, panting and **distressed**, reaches the group. He pauses to catch his breath, then addresses them anxiously.)*



MERCHANT : *(Breathlessly)* Good day, kind sirs.

ALL FOUR : Good day, brother.

MERCHANT : I seek your help. My camel has gone **astray**. Have you, by chance, seen it?

astray: away from the correct path

RAM DATT : Is your camel lame in one leg, by any chance?

MERCHANT : *(Surprised)* Yes, yes, it is!

SHIV DATT : Is it blind in the right eye?

MERCHANT : Precisely! It is blind in one eye—the right one, as you say.

HAR DATT : And does it have a short tail?

MERCHANT : *(Astonished)* You describe it perfectly! Yes, it has a short tail.

DEV DATT : Tell me, sir, has it not been suffering from a pain in the stomach?

MERCHANT : *(Taken aback)* How could you possibly know that? The poor creature has been unwell for two weeks now. Surely you are a healer! I will gladly pay your fee if you can cure it. But tell me, where is my camel?

RAM DATT : We regret to inform you that we do not know where it is.





indignant:
angry

yonder: over
there

SHIV DATT : We have not seen your camel, not even once.

MERCHANT : (**Indignant**) How can that be? You speak of my camel as if it stood before you, yet you dare to claim not to have seen it! You are deceivers! You must have stolen it and sold it off. I will take this matter to the King himself.

DEV DATT : You are free to do as you wish, sir. If the King desires our presence, we shall be waiting under that banyan tree **yonder**.

MERCHANT : I do not trust your words. I will not leave you here to slip away. You shall come with me to face the King!

ALL FOUR : Very well. We shall go to the King.

(They follow the Merchant towards the city gates. As they arrive at the palace, the Merchant speaks urgently to a Sentry. The Sentry leads the Merchant inside.)

Let us discuss

I Complete the following sentences with suitable reasons. One example has been done for you. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

1. Shiv Datt said, "I believe it has been over a week, perhaps even longer," because it had been a long time since they left the village.
2. Dev Datt said, "Indeed, we ought to be united in this hope. That is why we press on towards Ujjain," because _____.
3. Har Datt said, "Look there, friends. A camel has passed this way. The tracks are fresh," because _____.
4. Shiv Datt said, "It appears to be a merchant, running as if pursued by trouble," because _____.
5. The merchant said, "How could you possibly know that? The poor creature has been unwell for two weeks now. Surely you are a healer!" because _____.
6. Dev Datt said, "You are free to do as you wish, sir. If the King desires our presence, we shall be waiting under that banyan tree yonder," because _____.

Scene II: The King's Court

*(The King of Ujjain sits upon his throne, surrounded by courtiers. The grand hall is adorned with rich **draperies**, tall columns, and a golden **canopy**. The King, regal in his bearing, watches intently as the Merchant and the Sentry bow before him.)*

KING : *(Commanding)* What is the matter that brings you to my court?

SENTRY : Your Highness, this merchant has come with a **grievance** against four travellers. He accuses them of stealing his camel.

KING : Bring forth the accused.

*(The Sentry bows and exits, returning shortly with the four young men. They bow respectfully before the King, maintaining calm despite the **accusations** against them.)*



KING : *(To the Merchant)* Speak your accusation clearly. I shall not tolerate any confusion in my court.

MERCHANT : Your Majesty, these men know every detail of my missing camel, yet they insist they have never seen it. They are undoubtedly the thieves. How else could they know so much about it?

KING : *(Turning to Ram Datt)* You, speak. What do you know of this camel?

draperies:
long thick
curtains

canopy:
(here) a cover
fixed over
a seat for
decoration

grievance:
complaint

accusations:
claims that
someone
has done
something
wrong





deduce: to determine by reasoning

discern: to see or notice something

foliage: green leaves and plants

RAM DATT : Your Highness, I discovered that the camel is lame in one of its legs.

KING : And how did you **deduce** this?

RAM DATT : From its tracks on the road, I observed that only three feet left distinct impressions. The fourth was faint, indicating a limp. The pattern of the tracks told the tale of a creature struggling to bear its weight evenly.

KING : (*Nodding thoughtfully*) Impressive observation. You have sharp eyes, indeed. (*To Shiv Datt*) And what of you? What did you **discern** about this camel?

SHIV DATT : I observed that the camel was blind in its right eye, Your Majesty.

KING : How did you arrive at this conclusion?

SHIV DATT : It had nibbled only on the **foliage** to the left of the road, leaving the right side untouched. The leaves on the right hung undisturbed, as if unseen. From this, I deduced it could not see with its right eye.



KING : (*Smiling*) Well-reasoned indeed. Such detail is not easily noticed by a casual traveller. (*To Har Datt*) And your finding?

HAR DATT : I discovered that the camel's tail is short, Your Highness.

KING : Explain how you came to such a conclusion.



HAR DATT : I noticed small droplets of blood along the track, likely from mosquito bites. A camel with a long tail would have **fended off** these pests with ease. These small specks told me of an animal lacking such defence, hence the short tail.

fended off:
guarded against

KING : (*Impressed*) You reasoned with great **insight**, showing both observation and deduction. (*Turning to Dev Datt*) And you, what did you observe that set you apart from your companions?

insight: a
clear/deep
understanding

DEV DATT : I noticed, Your Majesty, that the prints of the camel's forefeet were deep and clear, while those of the **sound** hind foot were faint. This indicated that the camel was drawing up its hind legs, likely due to discomfort. It moved cautiously, burdened by a pain in its belly, trying to spare itself further suffering with every step.

sound: healthy

KING : (*Marvelling*) Extraordinary! You have not seen the camel, yet you know it **intimately**. Your reasoning is **flawless** and speaks of wisdom that goes beyond mere sight. (*Turning to the Merchant*) Your accusations are baseless and misguided. These are men of wisdom, not thieves. Go, and continue your search for your camel, and be mindful of whom you accuse in the future.

intimately: in a
detailed way

flawless:
perfect

(*The Merchant, **chastened** and embarrassed, bows deeply and exits, his face red with shame.*)

chastened: felt
sorry

KING : (*To the four men*) You have demonstrated remarkable intelligence and the ability to see beyond the obvious. Such minds are rare and highly valued in my court. I extend to you the honour of becoming my advisers. Your **counsel** shall guide my decisions, and your wisdom shall be a **beacon** for my kingdom. What do you say to my offer?

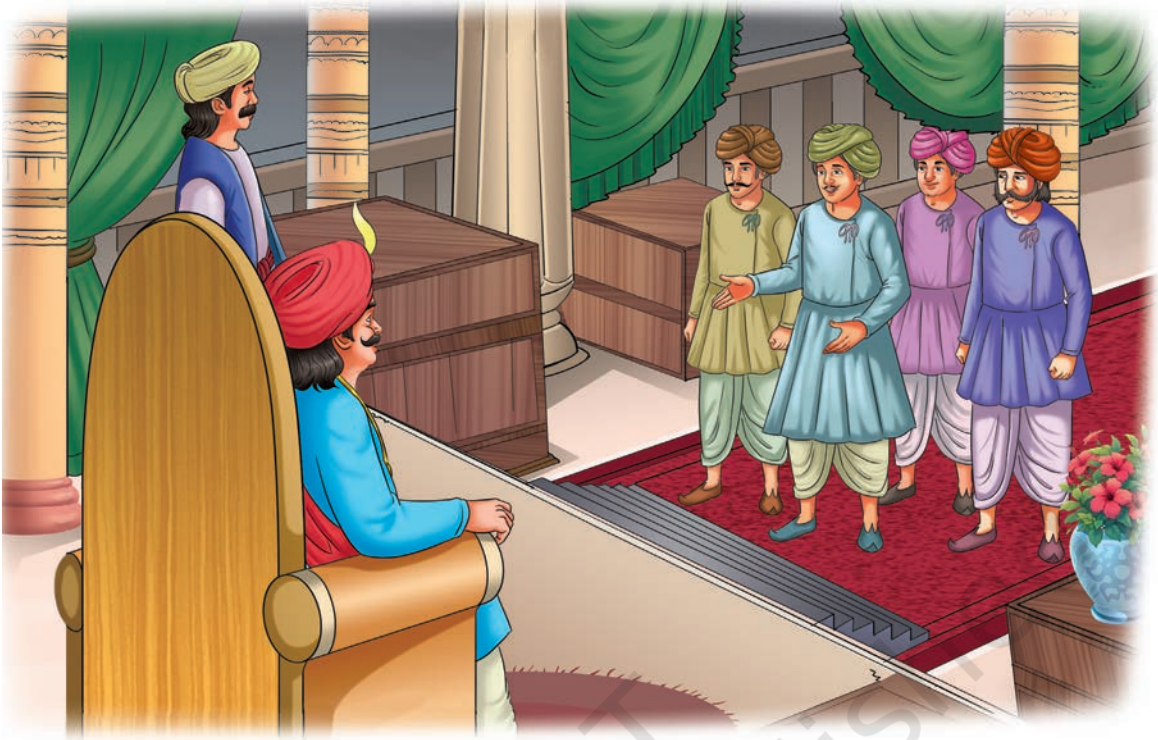
counsel: advice

beacon:
guiding light

RAM DATT : (*Stepping forward*) Your Highness, it is an honour we had not dared to dream of.

SHIV DATT : We are humbled and deeply grateful for your trust in our abilities.





HAR DATT : To serve a wise and just ruler like yourself is a privilege we accept with all our hearts.

DEV DATT : We shall dedicate ourselves to your service, offering our insights and counsel in all matters you see fit.

KING : *(Rising from his throne)* Then let it be known across the kingdom that four new advisers stand by my side. May your wisdom shine upon Ujjain and guide us to prosperity.

(The court erupts in applause as the King steps down to greet his new advisers. The four men stand proud and humbled, their journey fulfilled in a manner they had never anticipated.)

CURTAIN

Let us discuss

I Arrange the following events in order of their occurrence from Scene II of the play. One example has been done for you. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

1. The King makes the four young men his advisers, impressed by their skills. (8)

2. Ram Datt explains how he infers from the tracks that the camel is lame.
3. The King asks the merchant to clearly state his accusation.
4. The King praises the young men for their observations and dismisses the merchant's accusation.
5. Shiv Datt reveals that the camel is blind in its right eye as it had only chewed on the leaves on the left side of the road.
6. Dev Datt explains his observation about the camel's pain and careful movement.
7. Har Datt clarifies how he knew that the camel has a short tail.
8. The merchant accuses the four men of knowing a lot about his missing camel.



Let us think and reflect

I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.

1. DEV DATT : *Ten days are but a short span in the grand scheme of things. We may still have many more roads to wander before we find employment befitting all four of us.*

RAM DATT : *If only we could secure an audience with the King of Ujjain. I am confident he would recognise our talents and appoint us to his service.*

SHIV DATT : *I share your belief.*

DEV DATT : *Indeed, we ought to be united in this hope. That is why we press on towards Ujjain.*

HAR DATT : *(Pausing thoughtfully) Gaining an audience with the King is no simple task. We need to devise a strategy.*

- (i) Identify the false statement from the two given below and rectify it.
 - A. Dev Datt believes that finding employment is an easy task.
 - B. Ram Datt is confident that the King would recognise their talents.
- (ii) What does Ram Datt's confidence in gaining the King's recognition tell us about him?
- (iii) Complete the sentence given below with the correct option from those given.

In the line, '*That's why we press on towards Ujjain*', the phrase 'press on' refers to _____.





- A. walking with heavy steps
- B. moving forward with determination
- C. slowing down frequently for rest
- D. stopping briefly to save time

(iv) Har Datt says, "We need to devise a strategy." What can be inferred about Har Datt's character from his statement?

- A. He is doubtful of their abilities and wants to give up.
- B. He is eager to rush into the palace without preparation.
- C. He is cautious and thoughtful, preferring to plan ahead.
- D. He relies on others to make decisions for the group.

2. KING : *(To the four men) You have demonstrated remarkable intelligence and the ability to see beyond the obvious. Such minds are rare and highly valued in my court. I extend to you the honour of becoming my advisers. Your counsel shall guide my decisions, and your wisdom shall be a beacon for my kingdom. What do you say to my offer?*

RAM DATT: *(Stepping forward) Your Highness, it is an honour we had not dared to dream of.*

(i) Select the option that is true for both Assertion (A) and Reason (R).

(A): The Merchant left the court feeling humbled and ashamed.

(R): The King commanded that the four wise men join his court.

- A. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- C. (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- D. (A) is false, but (R) is true.

(ii) Complete the following sentence by choosing the correct option.

The line, 'See beyond the obvious' means that the men had the ability to ____.

- A. challenge common beliefs with reasoning
- B. interpret information in traditional ways
- C. notice details that others might overlook
- D. predict what is going to happen in the future

(iii) Complete the following sentence with a suitable reason.

Ram Datt described the King's offer as 'an honour we had not dared to dream of' because ____.

(iv) How does the King's offer to the four men reflect his values as a ruler?

II Answer the following questions.

1. What does the dusty road leading to Ujjain tell us about the challenges of the young men's journey?
2. Why did the merchant become suspicious of the four men? What does this tell us about him?
3. How do the four young men's observations about the camel serve as a turning point in the play?
4. Why did the King believe the four young men and not the merchant?
5. How does the capability of the four young men make them suitable to become advisors?
6. Why does the merchant feel ashamed for accusing the four young men of stealing his camel? Explain in your own words.



Let us learn

I Complete the sentences by filling in the noun form of the textual words given in the brackets.

1. Some word games need a lot of thought and _____. (deduce)
2. We need to make close _____ of animals in order to understand their behaviour. (observe)
3. A detailed _____ of the documents shows a lot of errors. (scrutinise)
4. You should not make any false _____ against anyone. (accuse)
5. She was given an award in _____ of her contribution to literature. (recognise)

II Match the expressions in Column 1 with their meanings in Column 2.

Column 1	Column 2
1. with all our hearts	(i) surprised
2. to be precise	(ii) starts cheering together
3. gain an audience with	(iii) hidden information that is not obvious
4. catch his breath	(iv) exact and accurate



5. erupts in applause	(v) meeting or hearing someone
6. grand scheme of things	(vi) complete sincerity
7. taken aback	(vii) to pause or rest for some time
8. more than meets the eye	(viii) overall plan of life in a larger context

Now, make sentences using any five of the expressions from Column 1.

III Match the different meanings of 'face' and 'bear' with the correct usage in the sentences given in the table below. (n. stands for the word noun and v. stands for the word verb.)

Words	Meanings	Sentences
face	1. (n.) the front part of a person's head from the forehead to the chin	(i) Ravi turned to <u>face</u> his father, when he was called.
	2. (v.) to be positioned with the face or front towards	(ii) The <u>face</u> of the clock was painted red and blue.
	3. (v.) to deal with a difficult task or situation	(iii) She has a round, smiling <u>face</u> .
	4. (n.) the front or surface of a thing	(iv) We should be ready to <u>face</u> life's challenges.
bear	1. (v.) tolerate	(i) The trees that I planted in my garden took a long time to <u>bear</u> fruit.
	2. (v.) accept	(ii) I spotted a <u>bear</u> on a wildlife safari.
	3. (n.) a large heavy mammal	(iii) Riya agreed to <u>bear</u> the responsibilities with confidence.
	4. (v.) produce; give birth to	(iv) I can't <u>bear</u> the sound of vehicles honking.

IV Match the highlighted words in the sentences in Column 1 with the functions they express in Column 2.

Column 1	Column 2
1. I will gladly pay your fee if you can cure it.	(i) expression of disbelief
2. You must have stolen it and sold it off.	(ii) imagined (hypothetical) possibility
3. You shall come with me to face the King!	(iii) moral obligation or advice
4. How could you possibly know that?	(iv) challenge
5. I am confident he would recognise our talents and appoint us to his service.	(v) logical conclusion
6. A camel with a long tail would have fended off these pests with ease.	(vi) wish or hope
7. They may tell us more than meets the eye.	(vii) necessity
8. May your wisdom shine upon Ujjain and guide us to prosperity.	(viii) prediction
9. Indeed, we ought to be united in this hope.	(ix) willingness
10. We need to devise a strategy.	(x) command
11. You speak of my camel as if it stood before you, yet you dare to claim not to have seen it!	(xi) possibility

V Complete the following story with modal verbs in the box given below by using the clues from the functions given within brackets.

may must should can
might could need to





An old man, known for his wisdom, lived in a small village. One day, a young boy asked him, “How 1. _____ (ability) I become wise like you?” The old man smiled and said, “Wisdom 2. _____ (necessity) be earned through patience. You 3. _____ (suggestion) listen, more than you speak.” The boy thought for a while and replied, “It 4. _____ (weak possibility) take years, but I’ll try.” The old man nodded. “You 5. _____ (obligation) learn from your mistakes too. Wisdom 6. _____ (possibility) come slowly, but it always arrives for those who seek it.” The boy knew he 7. _____ (ability) become wise if he followed the old man’s advice.

VI Rewrite the following sentences using appropriate modal verbs. You may take clues from the highlighted words. One example has been done for you.

1. It is **advisable** for you to think before you speak.

You should think before you speak.

2. It is **unnecessary** to worry about things beyond your control.

3. It is **not possible** for a person to gain experience without taking risks.

4. It is **essential** to treat others with kindness, even when they disagree with you.

5. It is **not allowed** to interrupt when someone else is speaking.



Let us listen

I You will listen to four people sharing their thoughts on why they enjoy witty characters in stories. As you listen, match statements 1–6 given below to the speakers (i)–(iv). There are two statements you do not need. (Transcript for teacher on page 48)

Statements	Speaker No.
1. Witty characters prove that cleverness is as powerful as strength.	
2. Witty characters show us ways to make learning enjoyable.	
3. Witty characters in a story keep the reader involved.	
4. Witty characters teach me that tricky situations can be managed calmly.	
5. Witty characters add excitement to a story by their extraordinary deeds.	
6. Witty characters can deactivate tense situations with their cleverness.	



Let us speak

I The way in which a word is stressed in a sentence can change its meaning. Read the following examples.

1. Look there, friends.	(look, not go or do some other action)
2. Look there , friends.	(look there, not here or somewhere else)
3. Look there, friends .	(is addressing the friends and not anybody else around)

Now, work in pairs. Take turns to say the following sentences aloud by stressing on the highlighted words. Share the meanings of the sentences with each other and teacher.

- I take my dog for a walk in the evening.
- I **take** my dog for a walk in the evening.
- I take **my dog** for a walk in the evening.
- I take my dog for **a walk** in the evening.
- I take my dog for a walk **in the evening**.

II Statements and exclamatory sentences usually end with a falling tone. Listen to the teacher read these sentences aloud and repeat it with the correct intonation.

Very well. We shall go to the king.

Yes, yes, it is!

Now, practise by saying the following sentences with the correct intonation.

- Good day, kind sirs.
- We regret to inform you that we do not know where it is.
- You describe it perfectly!
- You shall come with me to face the King!





Let us write

I You have observed that the *kutchra* road leading to your colony is in a very bad condition due to heavy rains. The potholes are dangerous for people and can lead to accidents. They also serve as a breeding ground for mosquitoes as there is stagnant water all around.

Write a letter of complaint to the Commissioner, Municipal Corporation or the *Sarpanch*, *Gram Panchayat* to look into the matter and take necessary action.

Follow the format of a formal letter and draft the letter with the help of cues given below.

Body of the Letter	Useful Phrases
Paragraph 1: state the purpose of writing and the issue	• I would like to bring to your attention... • I am writing to draw your attention towards...
Paragraph 2: give details and consequences of the problem	• The problems that we face are... • ... is causing inconvenience as... • As a result... • Consequently...
Paragraph 3: give suggestions and request for swift action	• Firstly, I would like to suggest... Secondly... • I request you to look into this matter and... • I look forward to your prompt response...



Let us explore

I Staging a play requires creativity, organisation, and teamwork.

Steps involved in staging a play:

1. Choose a play that suits your requirement of theme, duration, number of actors, and available resources.



2. Choose a director, a stage manager, a light and sound incharge, a props manager, a costume designer, and a makeup artist.
3. Hold auditions and decide the roles.
4. Read the script and plan stage movements, and positions for each scene.
5. Make a schedule for rehearsal.
6. Work on the set design (backdrop) and make or collect the required props.
7. Design or gather appropriate costumes.
8. Plan makeup and hairstyles to suit the play's time period.
9. Check light and sound arrangements.
10. Hold a dress rehearsal including sound and light effects.
11. Promote the event through posters and pamphlets.
12. Organise the backstage with labelled props, costumes, and actors' entrances or exits.
13. Present the play to the audience.

Now, present the enactment of the play 'Wisdom Paves the Way' with the help of the steps you have just read. Ensure you use the correct intonation and sentence stress.

- II Stories related to wit and wisdom have always fascinated the readers. Go to the library and read the stories associated with the following.

Vikramaditya and Betal

Tenali Rama

Gopal the Jester

Panchatantra Tales



"Let knowledge be the beacon that dispels the darkness of ignorance".

SAVITRIBAI PHULE

"The highest education is that which does not merely give us information but that makes our life in harmony with all existence".

RABINDRANATH TAGORE

